

Bakehouse: Deployment & Going Live Guide

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1. Choose a Hosting Provider

Since this is a Node.js app with SQLite, you need a server that allows persistent storage (so you don't lose the database on restart).

- Recommended: DigitalOcean Droplet (\$6/mo), Render (with persistent disk), or Railway.
- Do NOT use Heroku or Vercel unless you attach a persistent volume — their default file systems are temporary and your SQLite database would be wiped on every deploy.

2. Move from SQLite to a Production Database (Optional but Recommended)

SQLite is fine for very low traffic. But for an e-commerce site handling real orders:

- Consider migrating to PostgreSQL or MySQL for better concurrency and reliability.
- If you stick with SQLite: ensure you have a Persistent Disk and set up automated daily backups (e.g., a cron job that copies `bakehouse.db` to cloud storage).

3. Set Up HTTPS / SSL

Your site MUST run on HTTPS to process payments (Stripe and PayPal require it).

- If using Render/Railway: SSL is provided automatically with your custom domain.
- If using a VPS (DigitalOcean): Set up Nginx as a reverse proxy + Certbot (Let's Encrypt) for a free SSL certificate.
- Remove the self-signed certificate (`server.key`, `server.cert`) from production — those are for local dev only.

4. Configure Production Environment Variables

Create a `.env.production` file or set variables in your hosting dashboard. NEVER commit production secrets to Git.

- `NODE_ENV=production`
- `SESSION_SECRET` — change to a long, random, secure string (e.g., 64 random characters).
- `STRIPE_SECRET_KEY` / `STRIPE_PUBLIC_KEY` — switch from `sk_test_*` / `pk_test_*` to your LIVE keys from the Stripe dashboard.
- `PAYPAL_CLIENT_ID` / `PAYPAL_SECRET` — switch from sandbox to live credentials. Change `PAYPAL_API` to `https://api-m.paypal.com`
- `GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID` / `GOOGLE_CLIENT_SECRET` — update the OAuth callback URL in Google Cloud Console to `https://yourdomain.com/api/auth/google/callback`
- SMTP credentials — ensure they are correct for production.
- `GOOGLE_MAPS_API_KEY` / `MAPBOX_ACCESS_TOKEN` — restrict these keys to your domain in their respective dashboards.

5. DNS Configuration (Point Domain to Server)

In your domain registrar's DNS settings:

- Add an A record pointing to your server's IP address (for a VPS).
- Or add a CNAME record pointing to your hosting provider's URL (for Render/Railway).

- DNS propagation can take up to 48 hours (usually much faster).

6. Email Deliverability (SPF, DKIM, DMARC)

So your verification emails, password resets, and order confirmations don't land in spam:

- Add an SPF record to your domain DNS (provided by Zoho).
- Add a DKIM record (provided by Zoho).
- Add a DMARC record (e.g., `v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:admin@yourdomain.com`).
- Test deliverability at mail-tester.com.

7. Set Up a Process Manager

On a VPS, never run the server with just `"node server.js"`. Use PM2:

- `npm install -g pm2`
- `pm2 start server.js --name bakehouse`
- `pm2 startup` (auto-restart on reboot)
- `pm2 save`

8. Security Hardening

- Set secure cookie options: `cookie.secure = true` in session config when in production.
- Add Helmet.js middleware (`npm install helmet`) for security headers.
- Add rate limiting (`npm install express-rate-limit`) to prevent brute force on login/register.
- Ensure `.env` files, `.db` files, `node_modules`, `server.key`, and `server.cert` are in `.gitignore`.
- Disable directory listing (already handled by Express static).

9. Backups

- Set up a daily cron job to back up your database to cloud storage (S3, Google Cloud Storage, etc.).
- Keep at least 7 days of rolling backups.
- Test restore from backup at least once before going live.

10. Pre-Launch Checklist

- Test the full order flow end-to-end with LIVE Stripe/PayPal keys (place a real \$1 order and refund it).
- Test email delivery (registration, password reset, order confirmation).
- Test on mobile devices and different browsers.
- Verify all images load correctly.
- Set up basic uptime monitoring (e.g., UptimeRobot — free).
- Add Google Analytics or a simple analytics tool if desired.

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